

decades, the true scale of possibilities may actually reach further than what we imagine today.

Let's not forget that wearables face unique hindrances that will lead them to have less of an immediate impact on the market as compared to tablets or smartphones.

Especially since most of the devices, at the moment, need to be connected with a smartphone or tablet for the utilization most of their functionality.

Another salient issue comes up when we talk about wearables. Privacy campaigners have criticised that aspect of the technology, bringing to light that surreptitious sound recordings and even footage can be uploaded onto the cloud, that ending up being distributed and shared without the person's knowledge and/or consent. Along with obvious privacy issues relating to the general public, personalized information about the user of these gadgets gives rise to more data protection issues. For instance, it is known that certain health and fitness gadgets have GPS location features and have the ability to capture a large quantity of data over time about the user's location, activity and even health. This personal data may then be uploaded to the cloud and analysed by their technology provider. Of course, this is fine if the technology provider is transparent about how all the information is being utilized, shared and distributed, if at all the wearer has given his or her pre informed consent about what is being done with their data, and if the technology provider has put into place adequate and sufficient security measures to safeguard it. Whether this is carried out in practice is another matter entirely.

The more personal we get with our gadgets, the more information and data we are capturing about ourselves and the more privacy we expect in the long run.

Of course, there are always those tech wearables that we have mixed feelings about. Like Microsoft filing a new patent to completely revolutionize the way that wearable devices send out signals or notifications to wearers. Dubbed as "wearable computer having a skin-stimulating interface," the patent's abstract went ahead and named things such as alarms, phone calls and texts as some examples that people would literally be "shocked" about by the device.

The Marketplace

The year 2014 was hailed by many experts in technology as the "Year of the Wearable," hence reflecting an explosion of new wearable products with